

WEAREDEVELOPERS × BAND · DARK FACTORY · POCKETFUL

4/4 STAGES

Proof before ship.

Five AI seats build a wallet service. No seat accepts its own work.

Sravya Rachakonda · solo entry · October 2026

THE ONE RULE

**No seat accepts its
own work.**

5 seats • 1 code writer • 0 self-approvals

THE BAND

Five seats, one writer

01

coordinator

Routes every handoff. Never writes code.

02

analyst

Turns the spec into checks before any code exists.

03

builder

The only seat that writes product code.

04

adversary

Attacks the running service, black-box.

05

gate

Reruns everything. Accepts or rejects.

Claude Code on every seat • Opus 5.5 builds, Sonnet 5.5 checks • mandates name nothing track-specific

EVERY STAGE, EVERY ROUND

The loop



The gate holds its verdict until the adversary's report for the **same revision** arrives. We added that rule after the rehearsal.

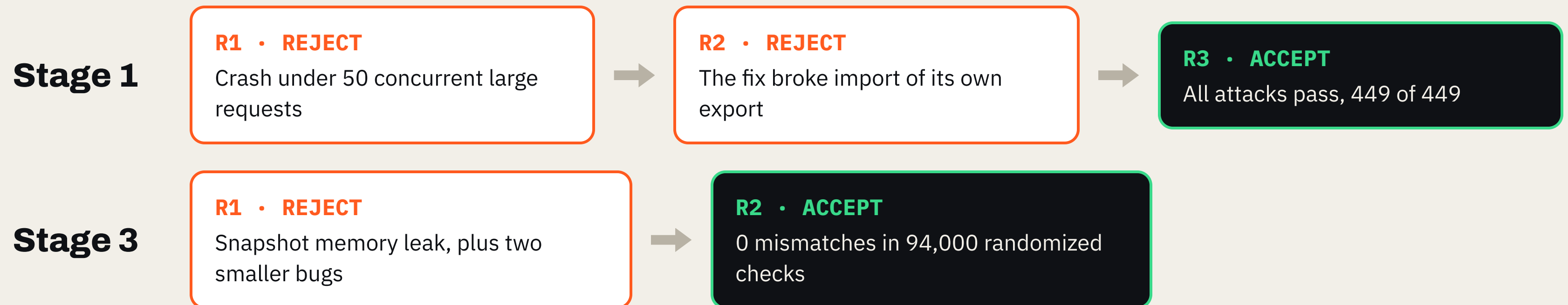
A large, bold, orange number 7 is positioned on the left side of the slide, serving as a visual separator for the main heading.

real defects caught before anything was accepted

Each one found by the adversary, reproduced by the gate, rejected with expected vs actual, fixed by the builder, then checked again.

ROUND BY ROUND

Review changed the work



Stages 2 and 4: accepted in round 1 • every rejection ships with a reproduction script

WHAT THE FACTORY DELIVERED

Four of four stages

4/4

STAGE 1 • ACCEPT

Wallet API, idempotent writes

STAGE 2 • ACCEPT

Browser app with holds

STAGE 3 • ACCEPT

Corrections and history

STAGE 4 • ACCEPT

Refunds and batch corrections

Fresh clone • isolated harness • no network • stage 4 oracle: 0 failures in 59,610 runs

The app the band built

stage-4 · synthetic demo data

Pocketful

WalletRequestsSplitHolds

Ada Lovelace
@adaLog out

Available to spend

446.50 EUR

Total balance

496.50 EUR

On hold

50.00 EUR

Money on hold is reserved for someone to collect, so it can't be spent yet.

Refresh

Send money

To

@

handle

Amount

15.00

EUR

Who can see it

Public — everyone

Note (optional)

What's it for?

Send money

Request money

Answers appear under Requests

From

Amount

Activity

Your payments, plus public ones between others

B

@bob paid @emma

BETWEEN OTHERS

Book club snacks

15.00 EUR

Public

Today at 06:39 PM

C

@cleo paid @dev

BETWEEN OTHERS

Climbing day pass

27.50 EUR

Public

Today at 06:39 PM

E

@ada paid @emma

SENT

Birthday gift 🎁

35.00 EUR

Public

Today at 06:39 PM

D

@dev paid @bob

BETWEEN OTHERS

Cab home

12.00 EUR

Public

Today at 06:39 PM

D

@ada paid @dev

SENT

Coffee run

9.00 EUR

Public

Today at 06:39 PM

C

@cleo paid @ada

RECEIVED

Concert tickets

42.00 EUR

Public

Today at 06:39 PM

B

@bob paid @ada

RECEIVED

Ramen at Ichiran 🍜

18.50 EUR

Public

Today at 06:39 PM

Pocketful

WalletRequestsSplitHolds

Ada Lovelace
@adaLog out

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446.50 EUR

Total balance

496.50 EUR

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50.00 EUR

Money on hold is reserved for someone to collect, so it can't be spent yet.

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To

@

handle

Amount

15.00

EUR

Who can see it

Public — everyone

Note (optional)

What's it for?

HUMAN INPUT, AUDITED

Every human word, on the record

0.2%

of 2,312 room messages were human

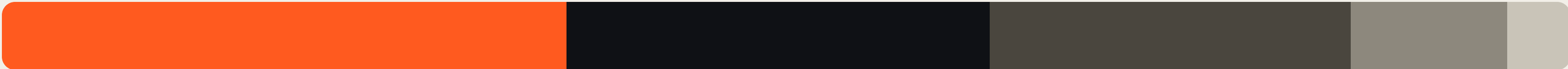
#1	The dispatch: task, specs, stance	737 w
#2	Resume after a usage limit stopped the builder	53 w
#3	Resume after a usage limit stopped the analyst	54 w
#4	A report was committed but never handed off	51 w
#5	Owner accepts verified work; the gate's ACCEPT follows	62 w

0 technical instructions · every trigger visible in the room · each one maps to a generic fix

MEASURED, PER SEAT, FROM EACH SEAT'S OWN LOGS

What it cost

\$123.87



■ builder · Opus

\$44.94

36% · 206 turns

■ adversary

\$32.95

27% · 233 turns

■ analyst

\$28.29

23% · 147 turns

■ gate

\$12.73

10% · 168 turns

■ coordinator

\$4.97

4% · 80 turns

Two thirds of the spend went on checking, not building. 96% of input tokens were cache reads, which is what lean, self-contained handoffs buy. API-equivalent list prices; the seats ran on a subscription.

HONEST LESSONS

What broke, and what we changed

INCIDENT

Usage limits

Five seats share one subscription; a stopped seat is never re-woken. Fix: API-key seats or a watchdog that re-delivers the handoff.

INCIDENT

Sleep

After a sleep, seats sat Reconnecting for hours. Now: charger, lid open, every seat Connected before dispatch.

FIXED IN REHEARSAL

Gate ordering

The gate ruled before the attack report. The mandate now makes it wait, and it held for the whole run.

NEXT

Fully dark

API-key seats so limits never stop the run, and a coordinator that polls for an overdue handoff.



ACCEPTED

Proof before ship.

Four stages, seven defects caught by the seats themselves, every claim backed by a file you can open.

github.com/Sravya1802/pocketful-dark-factory

